

1 — Reactivity: \$state

STATE MANAGEMENT

Q. How do you declare a variable that automatically updates the DOM when its value changes in Svelte 5?

ANSWER. Normally, JavaScript variables are completely dead: changing a `let` variable does not update your UI. You use the `$state` rune to wrap your initial value, turning it into a live variable that Svelte tracks. Any time that value changes, Svelte instantly updates the DOM for you.

```
<script>
  let count = $state(0);
  let user = $state({ name: 'Nikos' });

  function update() {
    count++;
    user.name = 'Hugo'; // Deeply reactive
  }
</script>
```

App.svelte

DIAGRAM CONCEPT. Dead Wire vs Live Wire: a plain `let` is a dead wire, change it and nothing reaches the page; `$state` is a live wire, every change is delivered to the DOM.

DEAD WIRE VS LIVE WIRE

PLAIN LET · THE DEAD WIRE

`let count = 0`

LOST

DOM: 0
NEVER ARRIVES

\$STATE · THE LIVE WIRE

`let count = $state(0)`

LIVE

DOM: {count}
ALWAYS DELIVERED

- ① **Summary.** A plain `let` is a dead wire: change it and the page never hears about it. `$state` makes the wire live, so every change is delivered to the screen and you never touch the DOM by hand again.